

$z = -2$ (weak regime)

PRIVATE BRIEFING

BOTTOM LINE: What you're seeing is not a rough patch – it's a pattern of accelerating deterioration.
ATMOSPHERE: The fear barrier has collapsed. People who were terrified last week are now openly discussing action.

EVIDENCE:

- [Elite Cohesion] a once-loyal advisor has been publicly contradicting official statements (near-unanimous confirmation from every reliable source)
- [Security Forces] rank-and-file soldiers are grumbling about pay delays and broken promises (overwhelming convergence – every channel telling the same story independently)
- [Money And Logistics] banks are imposing new withdrawal limits, citing 'temporary liquidity management' (overwhelming convergence – every channel telling the same story independently)
- [Street Mood] street vendors have returned to areas they'd avoided during previous periods of tension – the all-clear has been internalized (overwhelming convergence – every channel telling the same story independently)
- [Information Control] the regime's daily press briefing has been cancelled three times this week – they can't decide what to say
- [Personal Observations] people you trust are making quiet preparations – nothing dramatic, but noticeable (overwhelming convergence – every channel telling the same story independently)
- [Diplomatic Signals] international shipping companies have reclassified the country as higher-risk for cargo insurance (overwhelming convergence – every channel telling the same story independently)
- [Institutional Functioning] civil servants are reporting contradictory instructions from different parts of the bureaucracy (overwhelming convergence – every channel telling the same story independently)

UNCERTAINTIES:

- How deep the fractures go – surface-level dysfunction can mask either deeper rot or functioning parallel systems.
- Whether the military's silence means they're loyal, undecided, or waiting for the right moment.

$z = 0$ (ambiguous)

PRIVATE BRIEFING

BOTTOM LINE: The situation is balanced on a knife's edge – small events could determine which way it falls.
ATMOSPHERE: Trusted intermediaries are moving between groups, relaying assessments and gauging willingness.

EVIDENCE:

- [Elite Cohesion] elite cohesion is strained but not broken – rivalries are being managed rather than resolved
- [Security Forces] the security forces are maintaining presence but seem to be conserving resources rather than demonstrating strength
- [Money And Logistics] the currency is under pressure but hasn't cracked – traders are nervous but still trading
- [Street Mood] younger people are visibly more restless than older people, who counsel patience and caution
- [Information Control] the regime's information apparatus looks intact but tired – producing content without the energy or creativity it once had (a couple of contacts mentioning it independently)
- [Personal Observations] people seem watchful rather than panicked – paying closer attention but not acting differently
- [Diplomatic Signals] a regional power issued a carefully worded statement supporting 'institutional stability' – ambiguous enough to cover any outcome
- [Institutional Functioning] routine government business continues but with more errors and corrections than usual (a couple of contacts mentioning it independently)

UNCERTAINTIES:

- If external conditions change – an economic shock, a regional crisis – whether the regime's stability would hold.
- Whether the regime's recent successes have made it complacent about emerging threats it should be managing.

$z = +2$ (strong regime)

PRIVATE BRIEFING

BOTTOM LINE: By every measure available to you, the regime's hold on power is firm and likely to remain so.
ATMOSPHERE: Small gestures of solidarity happen – a knowing look, a shared silence – but nothing that could be called coordination.

EVIDENCE:

- [Elite Cohesion] a former rival of the leader has been publicly praising the regime's direction (near-unanimous confirmation from every reliable source)
- [Security Forces] a contact in the barracks says morale is solid and orders are flowing cleanly (overwhelming convergence – every channel telling the same story independently)
- [Money And Logistics] a major government infrastructure contract was just awarded – business as usual (overwhelming convergence – every channel telling the same story independently)
- [Street Mood] street vendors have returned to areas they'd avoided during previous periods of tension – the all-clear has been internalized (overwhelming convergence – every channel telling the same story independently)
- [Information Control] an opposition figure's leaked criticism was preemptively addressed before it gained traction – the intelligence apparatus is ahead of events
- [Personal Observations] a well-connected friend said the situation is 'messy but controlled' and seemed unbothered (overwhelming convergence – every channel telling the same story independently)
- [Diplomatic Signals] foreign students continue to enroll at local universities – their embassies haven't advised them to leave (overwhelming convergence – every channel telling the same story independently)
- [Institutional Functioning] civil servants are reporting contradictory instructions from different parts of the bureaucracy (overwhelming convergence – every channel telling the same story independently)

UNCERTAINTIES:

- If the regime's information advantage is as complete as it appears, or if opponents are communicating through channels you can't see.
- Whether any latent opposition exists that simply hasn't shown itself yet – absence of evidence is not evidence of absence.